

STAGE ELEVEN • TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY

FIRSTS

SESSION PLAN

Three sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 30 FIRSTS as a live workshop

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Eleven • Tools & Technology

OVERVIEW

Stage Eleven's thirty FIRSTS split across three sessions, matching the Manual's existing structure: Core Productivity & Office Tools, Personal Systems & Technical Foundations, and Advanced Tools, Automation & Optimization. Nearly every FIRST in this stage involves genuine hands-on use of a real tool, not just reflection — confirm participants have laptop access and relevant accounts before each session.

Some FIRSTS (O16 Git & GitHub, O21 CRM, O23 Workflow Automation) may require account setup or software installation that takes real time. Where possible, send setup instructions in the pre-work so session time goes to actual practice, not account creation.

AT A GLANCE

Time	Segment	Format
Session 1	Core Productivity & Office Tools — O1-O10	~135 min
Session 2	Personal Systems & Technical Foundations — O11-O20	~135 min
Session 3	Advanced Tools, Automation & Optimization — O21-O30	~140 min

SESSION 1

Core Productivity & Office Tools

Covers FIRSTS O1-O10: Tool Ecosystem Awareness, Productivity Tool Mastery, Microsoft Office Mastery, Google Workspace Mastery, Spreadsheet Tool Mastery, Presentation Tool Mastery, Collaboration Platform Mastery, Project Management Tool Mastery, Documentation Tool Mastery, Note-Taking System.

PRE-WORK

- Confirm participants have both a Microsoft Office and a Google Workspace account accessible — this session moves between both toolsets.
- Ask participants to bring one real, current document (a paper, a spreadsheet, or a presentation) to actually apply skills to during the session.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00-0:10	Welcome + framing: tool fluency is a genuinely learnable skill, not a fixed trait	Full group
0:10-0:30	FIRST O1 — Tool Ecosystem Awareness: map the landscape	Solo
0:30-0:50	FIRST O2 — Productivity Tool Mastery: commit to one tool	Solo
0:50-1:10	FIRST O3 — Microsoft Office Mastery: close one real gap, hands-on	Solo, laptops required

1:10–1:15	Short break	—
1:15–1:35	FIRST O4 — Google Workspace Mastery: practice one real-time feature	Solo, laptops required
1:35–1:55	FIRST O5 — Spreadsheet Tool Mastery: apply one advanced function	Solo, laptops required
1:55–2:10	FIRST O6 — Presentation Tool Mastery: learn one efficiency feature	Solo
2:10–2:25	FIRSTS O7–O8 — Collaboration Platform + Project Management Tool Mastery	Solo
2:25–2:40	FIRSTS O9–O10 — Documentation Tool Mastery + Note-Taking System + close	Solo, then full-group close

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This session is hands-on and device-dependent throughout; confirm laptop access for the whole group before starting, not partway through.
- FIRSTS O3 and O4 work best applied to a real, current document rather than a hypothetical one — remind participants to bring one during pre-work.
- If running long, FIRSTS O7–O9 can compress into quicker, more directive walkthroughs since they build on skills already practiced earlier in the session.

SESSION 2

Personal Systems & Technical Foundations

Covers FIRSTS O11–O20: Calendar Management System, Task Management System, Cloud Storage System, File-Sharing System, Version Control Awareness, Git & GitHub Exposure, AI Tool Exploration, AI Productivity Workflow, Data Visualization Tool, Database Tool Exposure.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to create a free GitHub account before this session if they don't already have one — FIRST O16 requires hands-on access.
- Confirm participants have access to at least one AI tool (a free tier is sufficient) for FIRSTS O17 and O18.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today is about building reliable personal systems, then extending into newer technical territory	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST O11 — Calendar Management System: full migration	Solo, laptops/phones required
0:25–0:40	FIRST O12 — Task Management System: set up + define review cadence	Solo
0:40–0:55	FIRST O13 — Cloud Storage System: migrate scattered files	Solo, laptops required
0:55–1:00	Short break	—
1:00–1:15	FIRST O14 — File-Sharing System: review and correct permissions	Solo
1:15–1:30	FIRST O15 — Version Control Awareness: locate and test version history	Solo
1:30–1:50	FIRST O16 — Git & GitHub Exposure: complete one real action	Solo, laptops required, GitHub account needed
1:50–2:10	FIRSTS O17–O18 — AI Tool Exploration + AI Productivity Workflow	Solo, laptops required
2:10–2:30	FIRSTS O19–O20 — Data Visualization Tool + Database Tool Exposure + close	Solo, laptops required, then full-group close

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST O16 (Git & GitHub) often takes longer than expected for genuine first-timers; budget real time for troubleshooting account or setup issues.
- FIRSTS O11–O13 all follow the same “full migration” principle — name that pattern explicitly rather than treating each as an unrelated task.

- If a participant is already comfortable with Git, let them help a nearby participant rather than sitting idle — peer teaching works well here.

SESSION 3

Advanced Tools, Automation & Optimization

Covers FIRSTS O21–O30: CRM Tool Exposure, Automation Tool Exploration, Workflow Automation, Integration Between Tools, Tool Comparison Exercise, Tool Selection Exercise, Software Troubleshooting Exercise, Digital Security Tool Awareness, Professional Software Stack, Tool Efficiency Audit.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to identify one real, repetitive task in their own life before the session — this becomes the working example for FIRSTS O22 and O23.
- This is the final session of the stage; let participants know they'll close by mapping their full tool stack, not just this session's tools.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: this session moves from individual tools to how they work together as a system	Full group
0:10–0:20	FIRST O21 — CRM Tool Exposure: hands-on exploration	Solo, laptops required
0:20–0:35	FIRST O22 — Automation Tool Exploration: identify a real candidate task	Solo
0:35–1:00	FIRST O23 — Workflow Automation: build and verify a real automation	Solo, laptops required
1:00–1:05	Short break	—
1:05–1:25	FIRST O24 — Integration Between Tools: connect two real tools	Solo, laptops required
1:25–1:45	FIRSTS O25–O26 — Tool Comparison + Tool Selection Exercise	Solo
1:45–2:00	FIRST O27 — Software Troubleshooting Exercise	Solo
2:00–2:15	FIRST O28 — Digital Security Tool Awareness: adopt one real practice	Solo
2:15–2:40	FIRSTS O29–O30 — Professional Software Stack + Tool Efficiency Audit + stage close	Solo, then full-group close

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST O23 (Workflow Automation) is the most technically ambitious exercise in the stage; have a simple, low-stakes example ready (an email filter, a recurring calendar reminder) for participants who get stuck on a more complex idea.
- FIRSTS O29 and O30 are the capstone of the entire stage, not just this session — give them genuine room rather than rushing if earlier segments ran long.
- Close the full stage by having each participant name one specific tool they identified in O30 that they're genuinely dropping, not just one they're adding.

- This is a natural moment to preview Stage Fourteen (Project Management), which builds directly on the project management tool fluency from O8.